SCIENCE DEPARTMENT • SCIENCE LITERACY & LESSON INTERNALIZATION

PLC AGENDA

Writing Samples + Unit-Test Evidence → A Better Next Learning Experience

Science Literacy Evidence Cycle — Use a small evidence set from the same benchmark to identify one learning pattern and adjust the next lesson.

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 30, 2026 | **46 MINUTES** | **GRADES 9–12 SCIENCE • BRING FORMS & EVIDENCE**

TODAY'S OUTCOME Leave with one supported learning pattern from completed or revised CER writing samples plus unit-test evidence where available, one next student action, one adjusted learning experience, and one new evidence check tied to the same priority standard and skill.

WHY THIS PLC MATTERS Student work is the bridge from a planned task to the next instructional decision. Reviewing completed or revised CER writing samples with unit-test-by-standard/question evidence where available helps teams confirm or complicate an instructional pattern without turning the conversation into a ranking of students, courses, or teachers.

PROTOCOL CONNECTION
Every Day Question 1: anchor in the task, student product, exemplar, and criteria. Questions 3–4, Team Deep Dive Steps 3–5, and After-Lesson Reflection: analyze evidence, choose a student action and teacher move, and set the next evidence check.

WHAT TO BRING
A few de-identified completed or revised CER writing samples or comparable science responses from the same benchmark; task/source/evidence; priority standard and success criteria; feedback or CUBS/CER notes where used; unit-test results by standard/question where available; next lesson; Lesson Internalization Tool.

FOCUS TO PROTECT
Use writing samples as the primary evidence. Unit-test evidence is contextual and optional. Describe what the work shows; do not rank students, teachers, or courses, and do not create a broad reteach plan.

TODAY'S PLC PLAN

TIME (MIN)	FOCUS	WHAT TO DO	PRODUCT / CHECK
0:00–4:00	**Reconnect to the evidence story**	Restate the same benchmark task, criteria, feedback prompt, student action, and evidence look-for from Monday through Wednesday.	**Evidence story**
4:00–9:00	**Restate the bar for mastery**	Use the task, source/evidence, student product, exemplar, and criteria to clarify what successful science thinking should make visible.	**Shared bar**
9:00–19:00	**Analyze student work**	Examine completed or revised CER writing samples first against the bar for mastery. Add unit-test-by-standard/question evidence when available for context, not to rank or label.	**Evidence notes**
19:00–31:00	**Identify one supported pattern**	Describe what the evidence shows about the priority criterion and name one instructional question that matters for the next lesson.	**Learning pattern**
31:00–41:00	**Adjust the next learning experience**	Choose the student action, teacher move, and short evidence check that respond to the pattern while maintaining grade-level cognitive demand.	**Next response**
41:00–46:00	**Close the cycle**	Confirm what will be collected, what the team will look for, and when the next course-alike decision will occur.	**Evidence plan**

PROTECTED INDIVIDUAL WORK WITH COLLEAGUE SUPPORT

WORK WITH COLLEAGUES

WHAT TO DO Use the protected work block to identify the instructional pattern and next lesson adjustment independently first; then use colleagues to test whether the student action, teacher move, and evidence check are justified by the writing samples and available unit-test context.

1. **Anchor in the agreed bar:** Use the task, criteria, exemplar, and expected science thinking before interpreting the evidence.
2. **Analyze student work first:** Review a few de-identified completed or revised CER writing, explanation, model, data-analysis, or investigation responses from the same benchmark.
3. **Add unit-test context where available:** Use standard/question evidence only to confirm, complicate, or redirect the instructional question—not to rank or label.
4. **Describe one supported pattern:** State what the evidence shows students can do and what they need to strengthen for the next science task.
5. **Adjust + set the evidence check:** Name the student action, teacher move, next learning experience, and brief evidence that will show whether it worked.

USE THIS REFERENCE DURING GROUP WORK

ANALYZE STUDENT WORK WITHOUT RANKING
Start with completed or revised CER writing samples from the same task and the agreed bar for mastery. Use unit-test-by-standard/question evidence where available to add context—not to compare people or courses.

DESCRIBE THE PATTERN
What does the evidence show about the priority claim, evidence selection, scientific reasoning, academic language, representation use, or a misconception? Keep the statement specific and instructional.

ADJUST THE NEXT EXPERIENCE
Decide what students will do next and what teacher move will preserve the science thinking. Then name the brief evidence that will show whether the adjustment worked.

COLLABORATION IN PRACTICE Protect time for thoughtful individual work; use respectful, student-centered feedback to make the next decision clearer.

TEACHER RUBRIC CONNECTION **Standard I: I-A-4 Well-Structured Lessons • Standard II: II-D-2 High Expectations • Standard IV: IV-A-1 Reflective Practice • Standard IV: IV-C-1 Professional Collaboration**

